

FILE : T01_AI_Intro_Webinar_2026-10-01_1649.md
CREATED : 2026-10-01_1649 UTC
PURPOSE : Teacher lesson plan for "AI for Small Business Owners in 60 Minutes" (free webinar).
READ FIRST: 00_IEBC_Teaching_Playbook_2026-10-01_1649.md
PDF GENERATED : 2026-10-01_1702 UTC

T01 Teacher Guide: AI for Small Business Owners in 60 Minutes

Format	Free live webinar on Zoom, recorded for replay
Length	60 minutes
Group size	Up to 100 (Producer required)
Level	Beginner, no experience assumed
Demo business	Lakeside Home Services
Student deliverable	Their personal "First Five" automation list + IEBC starter prompt pack

Purpose of this class

This is the front door of the Academy. Most attendees are curious but skeptical, and many feel behind. Your job in 60 minutes: (1) make AI feel practical and safe, (2) give them one real win during the webinar, and (3) send them away with a short list of what to automate first. A good webinar makes people want the next class because it was useful, not because it was a sales pitch.

Learning objectives

By the end, attendees can:

1. Explain the difference between an AI assistant, an automation and an AI agent in one sentence each.
2. Use a simple 4-part prompt (role, context, task, format) to get a useful draft.
3. Name at least five tasks in their own business worth automating, ranked by impact.

Materials and prep

- Slides (IEBC template), 12–15 slides max
- "First Five" worksheet (fillable PDF or Google Doc copy link)
- IEBC starter prompt pack (10 prompts: follow-up email, quote cover letter, review reply, social post, job description, meeting summary, FAQ answer, policy draft, invoice reminder, "explain this to me simply")

- Lakeside demo files: a sample customer email, a photo of a receipt, one paragraph about a completed job
- One AI assistant open and signed in (any mainstream assistant), plus a backup recording
- Producer: poll questions loaded, chat welcome message, links ready to paste

Run of show

Time	Segment	★/◆/○
0:00–0:05	Welcome and chat warm-up	★
0:05–0:15	What AI is (and isn't) for a small business	★
0:15–0:35	Three live demos	★
0:35–0:45	Try it now: everyone writes one prompt	★
0:45–0:55	The time audit and your First Five	★
0:55–1:00	Q&A, next steps, survey	★

0:00–0:05 · Welcome

Objective: People feel welcome and start participating in the first two minutes.

- ★ Say who you are in two sentences, and that IEBC builds these systems for real businesses.
- ★ Recording notice and that cameras can stay off.
- ★ Chat warm-up: *"In the chat: what kind of business are you in, and what task eats most of your week?"* Producer reads a few out loud. You'll reference these later.
- ○ A quick personal story about the first time AI saved you real time.

0:05–0:15 · What AI is (and isn't)

Objective: Attendees can sort tools into three buckets.

★ MUST TEACH:

1. **AI assistant:** you ask, it drafts (writing, summarizing, brainstorming).
2. **Automation:** when X happens, do Y, every time, no AI required (form → email).
3. **AI agent:** an assistant that can take steps on its own within rules you set, with a human signing off.
4. **Where AI is reliable today:** drafting, summarizing, reformatting, categorizing. **Where it still needs a human:** facts, math it can't check, anything legal/tax/medical, anything sent to a customer without review.
5. The data rule (Playbook §7.1), said plainly.

◆ RECOMMENDED: Rough cost picture: most assistants have free tiers; paid plans cost about as much as a streaming subscription.

Check: Poll: *"A form that emails you when someone fills it out is: an assistant / an automation / an agent?"* (Answer: automation.)

0:15-0:35 · Three live demos (SHOW)

Run each demo in about 6 minutes. Narrate the *why*.

Demo 1: Customer follow-up in 30 seconds ★

1. Paste the Lakeside sample customer email (a homeowner asking about a water heater quote).
2. Prompt with the 4 parts, typed slowly so people can read: *"You are the office manager at a small plumbing company (role). A homeowner asked for a water-heater replacement quote; we can visit Thursday or Friday (context). Write a friendly reply offering both times and asking for the heater's age (task). Under 120 words, no jargon (format)."*
3. Read the result out loud. Edit one sentence by hand. ★ Point out: *"I still read it before sending."*

Demo 2: Receipt photo to bookkeeping entry ★

1. Upload the receipt photo. Ask the assistant to extract vendor, date, total and a suggested expense category as a table.
2. ★ **Show the mistake moment:** point out anything it got wrong or guessed (category is often a guess). If it gets everything right, ask it for the tax deduction amount and show that it shouldn't be trusted for that. Say: *"Draft, then check."*

Demo 3: A week of social posts from one job ♦

1. Paste the paragraph about a completed job. Ask for 5 short posts for different days, each with a different angle (before/after, tip, customer story, team, offer).
2. Show how to ask for changes: *"Make post 3 sound more like a person and less like an ad."*

Watch for: People asking which tool is "best." Answer: *"The one you'll use. Today's skill works in all of them."*

0:35-0:45 · Try it now (TRY)

Objective: Every attendee gets one real result during the webinar.

- ★ Producer pastes the 4-part prompt template into chat.
- ★ Attendees pick one real message they need to write this week (with private details removed) and use the template in any assistant.
- ★ Ask 2–3 people to paste their before/after into chat or unmute. Celebrate specifics.
- Stretch (for those already using AI): add *"Ask me 3 questions before you write"* to the prompt and compare results.

Watch for: Attendees without an AI account. Producer pastes signup links; they can follow along and try after.

0:45-0:55 · The time audit and your First Five

★ MUST TEACH:

1. Open the First Five worksheet. Explain the score: **how often × how long × how much you hate it** (each 1-3).
2. Live example: fill in three Lakeside tasks on screen (quotes, invoice reminders, appointment confirmations) and score them.
3. Attendees list and score their own tasks for 5 minutes. Producer plays quiet timer music.
4. Circle the top five. Explain: *"Your highest score is your first automation."*

0:55-1:00 · Q&A and next steps

- ★ Take 2-3 questions (Producer has picked them from chat).
- ★ Next steps, said once, without pressure:
 - Start with your #1 task this week using the prompt pack.
 - If you want to build automations with guidance: *AI Admin Automation* (self-paced) or the 4-week live cohort.
 - Industry tracks exist for trucking, trades, creatives and nonprofits.
- ★ Feedback survey link. Replay goes out within 24 hours.

Follow-up email (send within 24 hours)

Subject: Your AI starter kit from today's webinar

Thanks for joining "AI for Small Business Owners in 60 Minutes."

- Replay: [link]
- Starter prompt pack: [link]
- First Five worksheet: [link]

Your homework (5 minutes): pick the #1 task on your list and try one prompt from the pack this week.

Want to keep going? See all classes at the IEBC Academy: [link]

Common questions and suggested answers

Question	Answer
"Is my data safe in these tools?"	Depends on the tool and plan. Default rule: don't paste personal or financial details unless your company has approved that tool for that data. Business plans often have stronger privacy terms.
"Will AI replace my staff?"	In small businesses it mostly removes the tasks nobody wants to do. The owners we work with use the time to take on more customers.
"Which tool should I buy?"	Start with a free tier of any mainstream assistant. Pay only when you hit limits on something you use every week.

Question	Answer
"Can it do my taxes?"	It can organize records. Tax decisions belong with a licensed tax professional.

Tool notes (update quarterly)

- Last verified: 2026-10-01. Demos work in any mainstream assistant that accepts image uploads.
- If image upload isn't available on the free tier you're using, run Demo 2 from the backup recording.